ISSUE #3

MARCH 2026

Holly Road & East Park Parade

Residents Association

HELLO NEIGHBOURS!

Spring is here — and so is Issue #3!

The Holly Road & East Park Parade Residents Association is all about making our neighbourhood a place we're proud to live in: greener streets, friendlier faces, and a stronger community.
This issue is packed with ways to get involved — from a spring planting day and sunflower competition to a sunset Glow Fun Run later in the year.
Read on, get inspired, and come join us!

SPRING EVENTS & ACTIVITIES

PLANTING DAY & SPRING CLEAN

On the **29th of March from 11am,** as the clocks change and give us one more hour to enjoy the daylight, we would like to invite you for a planting day and spring street cleaning followed by a picnic over the racecourse! All are welcome, just bring some nibbles and drinks to enjoy!
Thanks to Kate we will also start a sunflower competition!
Nurture it all spring — then join us again at the **end of July** for judging day.
The grower of the tallest flower wins!

OUR FIRST FAMILY FUN RUN !

We're proposing a community **Glow Fun Run in the Racecourse**, close to the autumn equinox. The run takes place at sunset — each participant carries a glow stick, creating a winding snake of light through the park. Great fun for all ages!
Organised by **neighbour Kirk Wilde's professional events company**, the event will be fully insured and professionally managed. Entry details to follow via a dedicated website. Any surplus funds will support community projects including artwork, planting and security improvements. **Volunteers welcome!**

NEIGHBOURHOOD UPDATES

LITTER PICKING

Join us on the **first Sunday of every month** for a litter pick along the service road and surrounding streets. Bring your own bin bags and a grabber if you have one — all welcome!

GRAFFITI & MURALS PROJECT — DONATIONS WELCOME

Graffiti has been increasing in the area, so we're launching a project to paint over affected spots and replace them with colourful murals celebrating local history — **led by our artist-in-residence, Bill.**
We're applying for council funding, but this isn't guaranteed. If you can contribute funds towards paint and materials, or donate your time to help with the painting, we'd be very grateful.
How to Donate: Information to follow in WA groups.

NEW COMMUNITY NOTICEBOARD

Our new noticeboard is now up at the top of the service road, facing Abington Grove. It will carry updates on litter picks, local events, and neighbourhood news throughout the year.
Local resident businesses are welcome to add their card — just get in touch and we'll include it.

SERVICE ROAD PLANTERS

Work has begun on a series of planters along the service road, with the first installed directly beneath the new noticeboard. More to follow as the project develops.

UPDATE ON THE PAVILLION FROM RICHARD CLINTON

Thank you to everyone who shared their views on the future of the Pavilion. Engagement has been excellent and the feedback thoughtful.
Key themes from residents included: preserving the building's character, keeping it accessible to all, supporting health and wellbeing, managing noise and parking, and ensuring it complements the park setting.
We will continue to engage with the local community and with West Northamptonshire Council as discussions progress.

MEET OUR LOCAL HEROES

A new segment focusing on members of our communities!

DAVID SMART

Jurassic Coast Ultra Challenge

On **16 May, David will tackle the 36-mile Jurassic Coast Ultra Challenge** alongside fellow Holly Roader **Andy Roberts and friend Alan Hakes.**
The date is no coincidence — it marks the anniversary of his sister Janet's death from epilepsy, 46 years ago.
David has channelled that grief into a career as a GP specialising in mental health, and for the past eight years he has chaired the Action for Happiness Northants Hub — a local branch of the national charity whose simple pledge is to create more happiness and less unhappiness in the world, starting with ourselves
.
The Hub is now at a critical point. With funding bids uncertain, **David is raising £2,000** to keep it going — money that will go directly towards two things: funding a Communications Lead to bring free, evidence-based wellbeing resources to local schools and the wider community, and running Champions Training to equip local people with the skills to spread happiness and resilience in their own neighbourhoods.

Closer to home, **David is building a network of champions around the Racecourse,** working with **Heather Korbey at Heather's Place** on Kingsley Road.

There's also a beautiful **"Hands of Healing" art installation** in the churchyard next to Abington Museum, honouring Thomas Prichard, superintendent of St Andrews, and his patient, the poet John Clare. As Hippocrates put it: "If you are in a bad mood, go for a walk. If you're still in a bad mood, go for another one." David's taking that to its logical conclusion — 36 miles of Jurassic coastline. He hopes to return euphoric.

Support David & AfH Northants: gofund.me/c953cf557 or linktr.ee/A4HNorthants
Support Andy Roberts: justgiving.com/team/andrew-roberts-7

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TERRY SLADE

London Marathon for Fibromyalgia

- ***Can you tell us a little about yourself and what inspired you to take on this challenge?***

I've been attracted to endurance sports since recovering from cancer (of the face) in 2018 and decided to do a triathlon as an incentive to learn how to swim well. Last summer I put my name into the ballot for the London Marathon. I'd just completed a half iron man distance triathlon and was feeling pretty fit (for a 65 year old). I've never run a marathon before, but no one gets in on their 1st attempt - or so I'd heard! Needless to say I got in!!

- ***Which charity are you raising money for, and why is it close to your heart?***

The charity is Fibromyalgia Action UK. Fibromyalgia is a chronic condition which causes fatigue and pain. Not a massive headline grabbing third sector machine by any description, but one which is close to our hearts as our youngest daughter Ruby is a sufferer. Diagnosis and treatment of her condition has been at best vague. We came across the charity as part of the journey into trying to find the best possible route for Ruby with this potentially life long chronic illness. The charity is developing it's offering and needs all the help it can get.

- ***How has your training been going? What has been the toughest part so far?***

Training has been going well – apart from very sore calves and the Christmas Flu which set me back by a good few weeks. The long training runs take over 3 hours now and it's starting to really eat into my time. It takes a lot of planning and a lot of patience from my family. I'm also about to become the Imelda Marcos of running shoes! Quite a collection now.

- ***What's your post-finish celebration plan?***

After the Marathon its straight into triathlon training for an event in June at Pitsford. That'll be a 1.9km swim, 90k bike and half marathon run.

- ***So not rest for the wicked! What would you say to anyone thinking of donating or getting involved?***

If anyone would like to make a donation we would be incredibly happy and grateful.

Donations are via my Just giving page **(see link in Community Group Chat via WhatsApp).**

CONTACT US:
We have a new email address:
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